



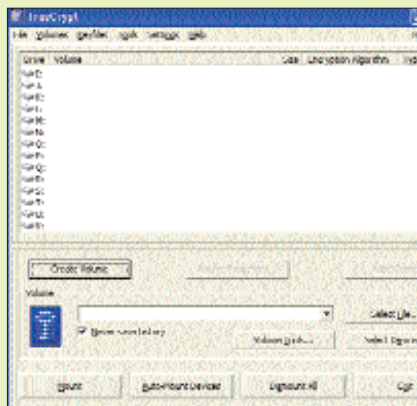
Encrypt Your USB Drive

USB drives are like keychains—they can easily be misplaced. You don't want your data in the wrong hands, so encrypt it and spoil the thief's party

Sanket Naik

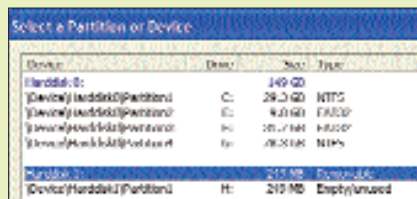
Here we will see how to encrypt a USB drive using TrueCrypt, a freeware tool. TrueCrypt is fast because it does encryption on the fly.

1 STEP Download And Install Download the utility from www.truecrypt.org/downloads.php. Unpack it and install it. The main interface is shown below. It looks sparse, but it's got everything you'll need.



TrueCrypt's user interface

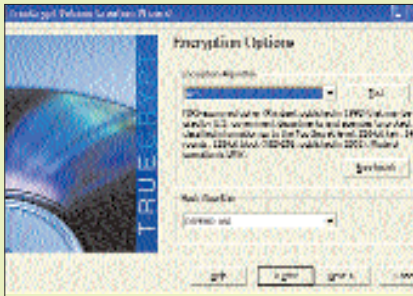
2 STEP Select What To Encrypt First we need to create a volume. On the main screen, hit the Create volume button and follow on to the next screen. Here, select Create Standard TrueCrypt volume and click Next. Once done,



Select whether to encrypt a Drive or a Device

you will get an option to create an encrypted Drive or Device—select Device. TrueCrypt allows for the creation of a volume on your hard drive, and it can completely encrypt a hard drive partition or a USB device. Since we are here encrypting a USB device, we selected Device in this step.

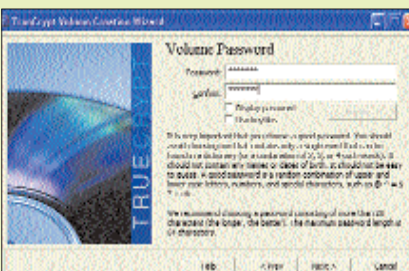
3 STEP Select Your Drive Once Device is selected, a small window opens, listing all the partitions on your hard drive. This will also list any removable



The digital levers that help safeguard your data

drives. Select the drive you want to encrypt and click Next—in our case, this will be the removable drive.

4 STEP The Actual Encryption This step deals with selecting the encryption and hash algorithms. We would suggest leaving this to the defaults if you are not sure. The default encryption algorithm is AES, which is an industry-wide standard, and reliable enough for most purposes. The hash algorithm used is RIPEMD-160. The drop-down menu lists many encryption algorithms and hash algorithms. A detailed explanation



Enter the key combination

about each is given in the Help file—we suggest you read it if you'd like to be in a position to be able to tweak the settings.

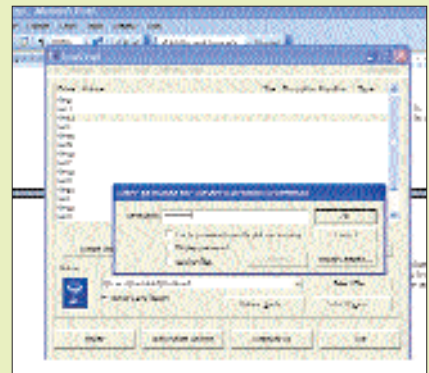
5 STEP The All-Important Password Here, the software will prompt you for a password, up to 20 characters in length. If you're encrypting critical data, we



The countdown before the lockdown

recommend you use at least an eight- or 10-character password for safety. Key in the password and then re-type it to confirm.

6 STEP Formatting Your Device The final step is to format the device. Here, you can select the desired file system and cluster



Enter your key combination to unlock your vault

size. Before clicking on Format, move the mouse at random for about thirty seconds to create a good encryption key.

7 STEP Use It! Once an encrypted volume is created, it needs to be mounted before you can access it. To mount the drive, open TrueCrypt and select any drive letter from the window, in our case, K. Then click on the Select Device button and select the encrypted volume (the USB drive). You will be prompted to provide the volume password; key in the password and the drive will be mounted. Once mounted, the drive can be accessed just like any other partition, and you'll be able to read from and write to it. ■

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